



Northernmost range
No wild monkey in the world lives further north than the Japanese macaque. Like macaques in the central mountains, they keep warm by bathing in hot springs.

Snow monkey
Japanese macaques living in the snowy mountains of central Honshu—close to ski resorts—have become a popular tourist attraction.

Deciduous forests
In the northern parts of their range, Japanese macaques range into mountainous areas with deciduous trees—trees that lose their leaves during the winter. At this time of year, macaques move to lower elevations, where there is more food.

Thick fur
The grayish fur grows especially long and thick on its back and sides, which helps trap body heat. The monkey molts its coat in late spring so its fur is shorter in the summertime.



Hot springs
In the mountains of central Honshu, temperatures plunge below freezing in the winter. Here, Japanese macaques survive the cold by regularly bathing in thermal pools that are common in this volcanic region.

Naked face
Pink skin shows through a very fine coating of fur on the face of an adult macaque, encircled by long, pale whiskers.



KEY

 Japanese macaque range